



VertiGO!!!

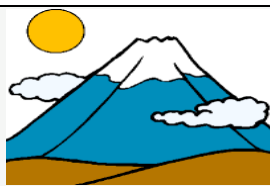
Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 712 October 2008 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Paretaitonga from the Whakapapa Col – Ruapehu's 3rd highest summit.



Section Night 6 October 2008

SHORT TALKS :

We have a selection of fabulous talks on offer: Work & Life in South Georgia (Anjali Pande), Transalpine Trips in Europe (Richard Davis), AIC 2008 (Mark Humphreys) and More.....

Summer is just around the corner - which means outdoor rock climbing! We have 10 copies available of "Wellington Rock" available for sale on club night - normally costs \$35, available to you for just \$25



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



Club trip: Tahurangi Peak, Ruapehu – 23 August 2008

Trip Leader: Blair Hiscoke.

Climbers: Blair, Hinrich Schaefer, Vincent Zintzen, Heidi Berkenbosch, Lou Thornley, Robert Hawes, Nigel Roberts, Steve Merchant, Lorraine Johns.

On Friday 22 August, a keen group of Wellington climbers set off for the big R, hoping to seek a summit and maybe even some sun, despite the wintry forecasts.

Waking up on Saturday, the outlook was a little grim. After talking to the ski patrollers, South Islanders Dan and Andy (friends of Lou) were ready to swap their own climbing aspirations for some seemingly more achievable ones involving beer. The drive up to Turoa skifield confirmed their promise of poor visibility. However, Blair suggested taking the day as it came, and heading to "mount café", which peaked at the top of the intermediate ski tow. Lured by the opportunity to make fun of some North Islanders, we were joined by Dan and Andy (they seemed to think cafés high on mountains were a soft North Island thing – although this did not prevent them from enjoying the comforts on offer).

From the café we decided to walk up to the top tow and by the time we got there, the departing wind had cleared the clag to reveal sun, a still blue sky, and of course, the summit! We got ready to crampon it up to the nearby ridge, and then on to the top. On the ridge, there was some discussion as to whether a group would make an attempt at Girdlestone. However, a snowpit suggested that this might lead to an uncomfortable degree of familiarity with the snowpack, so everyone headed for Tahurangi.

We reached the summit in various stages after midday and I think we were right where we all wanted to be. The view was stunning, the day sunny, and no wind – T-shirt and jandals weather! Nigel assumed

the role of group photographer, and took some great shots guaranteed to make those back in Wellington a little envious.

We left the summit just after two and pretty much slid down the mountain. I think the skiers coming up in the tows quite enjoyed watching this. They certainly had plenty of unsought advice for me...admittedly, on the harder snow of the ski slopes, my descent became noticeably less dignified than that of the others – a mixture of last minute self-arrest and being smacked by my ice axe.

Once we were down, some split off to check out a frozen waterfall, while the remainder went back down for food and, best of all, a shower. Our celebratory dinner plans were almost foiled by the fact that the entire town was booked out for dinner that night, but luckily we found a “gourmet” kebab shop nearby. Beer and not-quite-so-gourmet kebabs in hand, the girls relaxed while the boys compared their mobile phone rings and pondered which movie stars they resembled. On Sunday the weather packed in again, so we headed home, a fun and successful trip behind us.

This was actually my first snowy peak (having just done the 2008 AIC), and as a non-skier, one of the few times I have been in snow. It was, at times, a little hard on the calf muscles, and while ascending, I sometimes found myself gazing rather wistfully at the ski tows above. Luckily for me, the group – quite an experienced one – was very kind and encouraging. I learnt quite a bit on this trip, including that if you want to be a real mountaineer, you need a healthy stock of quotes from other mountaineers at the ready (no decision is complete without one of these). Also, if you want an ego boost, skiers are pretty impressed by avalanche transceivers and ice axes.

This was a great first trip to go on with a cool group of people, and I really enjoyed it, in particular the increased confidence it brought. I'm very much looking forward to my next trip and the promise of springtime climbing!

Lorraine Johns
Wellington Section AIC Graduate 2008



A Trip for the 'Leave Challenged'

Given most South Island trips are minimum 3 day commitments (day walk in, day climb, day out) we decided to use a bit of lateral thinking to successfully nail a near Nelson Lakes top 100 peak in under 2 days. Making a late Wednesday weather decision and spending \$270 got us an early Saturday flight to Nelson. Our rental 4WD got us across a 2' deep river and up 15km of track for a 3 hour walk in to a 1200m basin under Scotts Knob (2260m). Talk about avalanche damage, the basin was chocka with snow and several thousand smashed pine trees!

A 6am start the next day saw us take advantage of hard cramponing conditions under a BSD to summit by 9. After several hours lying around in the sun soaking up the majestic expanse of the Nelson Lakes peaks of Travers, Hopeless, Franklin and Kehu on one side, Tappy/Alarm in the distance on the other we slowly descended in the afternoon and exited to return to Wellington just after 8pm. Trip participants Kevin Patterson and Tom Zink.

See <http://www.facebook.com/album.php?aid=58249&l=5f23c&id=783826158> for the full story and

photo's.

Kevin Patterson



Happy Anniversary and 1st Summit - Paretaitonga (2751m) 6th September 2008

Bridie & Ben Allen, Jo Langridge and Stuart Clark

After a not so Alpine start, leaving the top o' the Bruce at 9am we took the easy option to the top of National Chairlift and walked up the west side of Whakapapa ski field. At the top of the Far West T Bar we traversed south to gain the Northwest Ridge. Ben and I had completed the AIC with TTC last winter based at Whakapapa in terrible weather conditions. Before today we hadn't even see the top from this side of the mountain let alone been near the summit. Between work commitments and poor weather this was our first good day on the hill. And what a great day it was! Bluebird skies and unlimited visibility, but a brisk southerly breeze that was unforgiving when we stopped to get crampons on. I experienced for the first time the agony of blood returning to fingertips after a period of numbness from the cold. Stunning views of a snow covered Ngauruhoe and Taranaki peeking out above the clouds made me wonder why people stay in the city for their weekends. Beautiful snow conditions made for easy progress up the ridge. We encountered a few Gendarmes and had to drop off the ridge to get past. These enormous bulges of snow and ice were decorated with shimmering icicles; some of us couldn't resist the childish act of breaking them off to eat! The temperature out of the wind was an amazing 20 degrees warmer than in exposed places! From the summit (after the compulsory summit jig and photos) we enjoyed panoramic views of the Summit Plateau with the Crater Lake decorating the vista; a milky shade of aqua. Descending towards the lake, eagerly anticipating lunch I learned about crampons 'balling up' and how it feels similar to roller-skating down hill without brakes! A picnic near the lake followed by a wander up to Dome shelter was making for a very pleasant way to spend a Saturday and fourth wedding anniversary for Ben and I. Jo learnt her lesson for the day after doing the 'pocket haka' with no relief. She dropped her pack and retraced her steps to the last known location of their camera – this was a good test of Fiancée` Stu's patience and understanding especially when it was nowhere to be found! During an uneventful descent via the Summit Plateau through The Notch we dropped into an airy mist under Pinnacle Ridge. A little late for a hot drink at the cafes or a chair ride down we enjoyed a warm, windless, walk over newly groomed pistes back to the car park. A great day out that roused an appetite for a hearty steak dinner, glass of red wine and a well earned restful nights sleep. Two down, ten to go to complete the twelve summits of Ruapehu.

Bridie Allen



Coming Soon.....



The NZ Mountain Film Festival

Coming to The Paramount is the NZ Mountain Film Festival hosted by the NZ Alpine Club

When: 6.30pm Tuesday 4th November

Where: The Paramount Theatre, 25 Courtenay Place, Wellington

Tickets: Tickets are priced at \$20 or \$15 for NZAC members.

Tickets are on sale at The Paramount.

Ticket sales for NZAC members will be at NZAC clubnights on 6th October and 3rd November.

Programme The NZ Mountain Film Festival is derived from the 'best' of this year's Wanaka Film Festival. The films to be featured will be:

A Most Ambitious Journey - Steve Gurney and Steve Moffatt re-enact the first ever Coast to Coast by George and James Park in 1889

Edge of Eden: Living with Grizzlies - Canadian conservationist Charlie Russell's struggles working with endangered grizzly bears in Kamchatka in eastern Russia

The Beckoning Silence - Tony Kurz's and Joe Simpson's battles for survival. Featuring a climb on The Eiger's North Face

First Light - This film takes you on a journey around the magical Otago and Catlins coastline to discover epic surfing

All enquires by email to **Nicky McIndoe**.

Banff Mountain Film Festival 2009

We're looking for a volunteer to organise the 2009 Banff Mountain Film Festival to be held again in April 2009.

If you're interested in helping out and want to find out more about what is involved please drop an e-mail to secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



CLASSIFIED



The Wellington Section is offering up it's topo map collection for sale.

We have on offer to members:

- one near full set of NZMS260 series (12 missing)
- a selection of 21 Infomaps and Parkmaps covering parks from Bay of Is to Fiordland
- a selection of 35 StreetFinder maps covering most provincial towns and cities
- one map cabinet

Total price for the lot is \$250.

All enquiries to James Wright on 04 2327748 or 0274725561 or email at james.wright@xtra.co.nz



Paintings by Pat Prendergast – Club Fundraiser

Club member and local Christchurch Artist, Pat Prendergast, has kindly offered a percentage from the sale of some of her paintings to help us raise funds for the Unwin Lodge Redevelopment Project. The paintings may be purchased directly from Pat by contacting her on 03 337 0079 or patp@orcon.net.nz and can be viewed either by going to the NZAC webpage <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=380> or by visiting weekdays at the National Office, Unit 6, 6 Raycroft St, Waltham, Christchurch.



Keep New Zealand Clean – Poo Pots

These are now available to be purchased from the Club's National Office, Unit 6, 6 Raycroft St, Waltham, Christchurch. At present we are just supplying for pick up as they are awkward to post, but if you are keen to have some sent out to you, it can be arranged for an extra charge. Cost for pick-up is only \$5 each. Help support the survival of our environment for future generations – Leave No Trace.

National Office contact: Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz



Arapiles – Selected Climbs

The new edition of this popular Australian Guide Book has finally arrived. We are only ordering in small lots as the guide is rather expensive to bring in. Stocks will be kept low at any one time, so may be backordered if demand is high. Member price is \$60, plus p&p (rrp \$75).

Please contact Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz at the National Office to order your copy.



Found – Ruapehu Hut

Haven't been able to trace the owners of a pair of Snowline Gloves left at Ruapehu Hut, probably sometime in July/August. If you think these might be yours and can tell me the brand and size they can be claimed from the National Office in Christchurch.

Please contact Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz phone 03 377 7595



CLUB NOTICES



NZAC Travel Insurance Policy

The NZAC has just had its annual Travel Insurance review and our broker, Peter Garrett, has been able to negotiate some improved benefits for Club members. Some of the main points are:

- partners and children of NZAC members can now apply for insurance without being members, as long as the primary applicant is a member.
- benefit limits have all increased considerably.
- the individual item limit has increased.

As premiums are remaining the same, a new insurance brochure won't be printed straight away, so the old ones are still fine to use for applications. The new Policy Wording with all the new benefits is now available online however and may be viewed under the Activities and Insurance heading on our website – Insurance-travel from NZ <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=23> The insurer has also agreed to look at, on a case-by-case basis, applications for cover to some competitive climbing events, so if you are considering entering any (especially UIAA sanctioned events) it would be worth your while to request a special endorsement to attend.



BMC International Winter Climbing Meet 2009 Glenmore Lodge 22 February to 1 March

We would like to invite your Federation to nominate two climbers from your country to take part in the British Mountaineering Council (BMC) International Winter Climbing Meet 2009 to be held at Glenmore Lodge in Scotland. This Meet is the sixth of its kind and will bring together climbers of all grades from around the world.

The aims of the meet are:

- To promote international friendships and increase communication between National federations.
- To give overseas guests an opportunity to experience the delights of Scottish winter climbing.
- To give guests an insight into British Ethics and Traditions.
- To provide a platform for international debate and discussion on current topics of concern in climbing and mountaineering worldwide.

We would particularly welcome applications from people who have not attended these meets before. Any climber with reasonable winter climbing experience can apply. Grade is not important. Please note that we will contact all Federations by **7 November** that return Form A. **Please do not make any bookings (flights, trains etc) until you have had confirmation of your places from the BMC.**

The BMC International Meets are truly memorable events so if you are interested please go to our website for further information.

Registration form A needs to be **RETURNED BY FRIDAY 31 OCTOBER 2008**



ROCK CLIMBING!!!!



Summer Rock 2009

Dates are on the web. <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?p=217>

The course starts on the 5th Feb at Fergs. The cost of the course is still been finalised but will be around the same as last year (about \$550.00). The course can cater for people who are new to climbing right through to people who want to develop their leading climbing skills. We will aim to get you lead climbing on bolted routes (sport climbing). The course will cover technique and movement on the rock/wall, belaying - including lead belaying, lead climbing, seconding on Pro, abseiling and the pros and cons of chocolate.

The course will be two weekends climbing around Wellington, a weekend in Wharepapa and a weekend at Whanganui Bay. A certain level of fitness is required. The course will be limited to 12 students with 6 instructors. Even though our instructors are volunteers, they are bench-marked by people holding an NZOIA Rock II. The Instructors are up with the current industry standards.



Rock Climbing Discussion Group

the club has had set up an email list for people looking for climbing partners. wellingtonrock@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz to log in to the email list send an email to wellingtonrock-subscribe@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz or go to the Wellington section web page and click on the Email Discussion Groups tab and go from there.

HIKING GUIDES WANTED

Established in 1993, Hiking New Zealand specialises in taking small groups of adventurous travellers hiking into New Zealand's best wilderness areas. We have vacancies available for full time guides starting in October.

What we offer:

- Competitive pay and incentives
- Excellent on the job training
- An amazing work environment!

Applicants should have:

- New Zealand tramping experience
- Great communication skills
- Excellent New Zealand natural history knowledge (or be prepared to learn)
- A "P" endorsement on driver licence
- Current first aid cert.

For job description and application form, please email info@hikingnewzealand.com or phone 03 376 6482.

HAVE YOU GOT A JOB LINED UP FOR THE SUMMER?

THOUGHT ABOUT GLACIER GUIDING?

Imagine living at the foot of our country's highest mountains surrounded by wonderful West Coast forest. The best climbing, tramping, hunting, diving and fishing in New Zealand is right outside your back door.

This is an opportunity for you to live and work in a unique environment where glaciers, rainforest and the ocean meet. You will be guiding visitors from New Zealand and all over the world on the Fox Glacier.

You will work with one of New Zealand's oldest and most highly regarded adventure tourism operators, a caring and progressive company and have an opportunity for professional training with the New Zealand Mountain Guides Association.

If you wish to guide with us you will feel right at home in the outdoors ;be physically fit; have an outgoing and enthusiastic manner and enjoy talking to a wide range of people from all over the world.

Your initial contract would be for the period start October 2008 – end April 2009. However, depending on our needs and your level of enjoyment, an ongoing position may become available. Applications will only be accepted on forms obtained from:

tracey@foxguides.co.nz

or
Fox Glacier Guiding
PO Box 3
Fox Glacier
Phone 03 7510 825
Fax 03 7510 857

View our website: www.foxguides.co.nz



**Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz**

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Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



CLUB TRIPS



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

19-21Sep08 – Egmont (2518m) - via Tahurangi lodge – Leader Nigel Roberts – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

We will leave early on Friday afternoon (4pm) to North Egmont car park, from where we will tramp up to Tahurangi Lodge (1.5h) arriving ca. 11pm. On Saturday we will ascend Egmont (2518m) via the Lizard,

returning to the lodge for the evening. On Sunday we will explore the rock walls of Warwick Castle (bring a rope for this trip) towards the eastern side before returning to the car park. Contact Nigel at 463 5288 (work) or email me at nigel.roberts@vuw.ac.nz



Mt Egmont Crater Wall

2-5Oct08 – Faerie Queene (2236m) – Lewis Pass/Nelson Lakes - Trip Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Thursday night we'll take the ferry and stay overnight at the backpackers at St Arnaud. On Friday we'll drive to Lewis Pass, then tramp to Ada Pass Hut (4-5 hours). Saturday will be the summit day, starting early we'll be ascending via Camera Gully, traversing along the ridge to Faerie Queene. If time and energy permits we'll traverse Gloriana Peak on the way back to make it a loop trip. Sunday will be the walk out to the hot pools at Lewis Pass before returning to the ferry and home in the evening. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Faerie Queene Summit

24-27Oct08 – Mt Manukau (2608m) – Seaward Kaikouras – Labour Weekend - Leader James Wright – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Spring snow trip to end the northern alpine season! Come on this challenging 3 day climb in the Seaward Kaikouras. On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Manaukau River followed by a climb up to a high Alpine basin where we'll tent overnight. On Sunday we'll attempt the summit via the north ridge. No ropes required. Contact James at 232 7748 or by email at james.wright@xtra.co.nz



Mt Manakau

21-30Nov08 – Tasman Saddle – Trip Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Set aside space in your leave calendar for this one! This will be a week long trip into the Mt Cook NP glacier zone. Multiple peaks abound within easy distance of Tasman Saddle Hut including Mt Green, Elie de Beaumont, and the infamous Hochstetter Dome. On Friday night we'll fly down to Christchurch and drive to Mt Cook village, staying in Unwin Hut. On Saturday we will fly in to Tasman Saddle by ski plane and spend the following 8 days climbing. Or whatever. Sunday lunchtime we fly back out, and then drive back to Christchurch to catch our plane home. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Upper Tasman Glacier

27Dec07 – 3Jan08 – National NZAC Climbing Camp – Matakitaki Valley (Nelson Lakes NP)

A great opportunity to meet fellow climbers from other club sections, and to team up to tackle some of the local peaks including the challenging Mt Ella (2253m). See <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=377> for details. Car pooling from Wellington is being coordinated through Kevin. Contact me at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



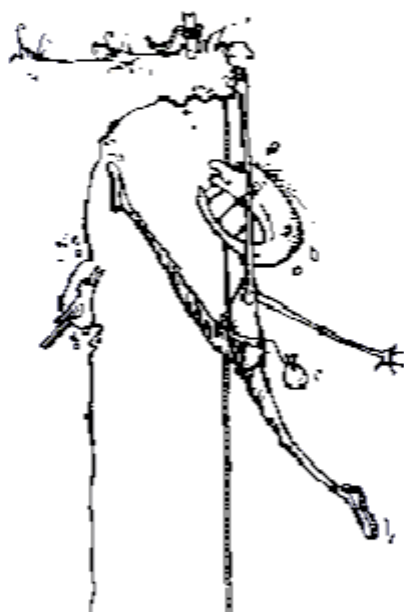
Mt Ruapehu's beautiful Crater Lake and Summit Plateau



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2008 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Jennifer Brown	JB2	027 292 0903
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Representative	Jennifer Brown and James Wright	JB2 <i>or</i> JW	N/A
	Garth London and Judy Reid	GL <i>or</i> JR	(04) 479 2984 (Garth)
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	N/A
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	Rachael Schmidt	RS	N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	N/A
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
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	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
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Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Phil Doole		N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

